PRE-SEED · €250K · NOVEMBER 2026

HI8CTANE

THE FORECAST SAYS GO.
WE GET YOU THERE.

Hi8ctane turns real-time conditions into real outings: the day rated for your level, a crew to ride with and a seat in the car. Starting with kitesurfing in Amsterdam.

Francisco Arredondo, founder · hi8ctane.com · hello@hi8ctane.com

A GOOD FORECAST ISN'T A SESSION

THE WINDOW

A few hours of good wind, known only a day or two ahead.

THE PEOPLE

Never kite alone: the first safety rule. You need riders at your level, free that same day.

THE TRIP

The spot is 30 to 120 minutes away, with a board, and many riders have no car. Barcelona to the Empordà: €39.81 in fuel alone, €9.95 each for four.

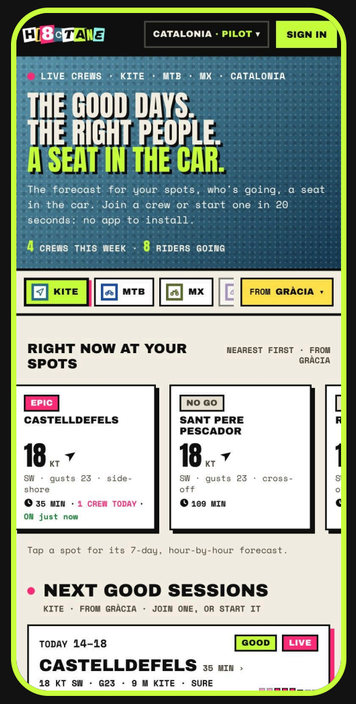
So riders juggle a forecast app, a WhatsApp group and a carpool site. Plenty of good days end at home.

Safety rule: VDWS, IKSA · Fuel: Sants–Sant Pere Pescador return, app trip calculator (6.5 L/100 km, €1.95/L)

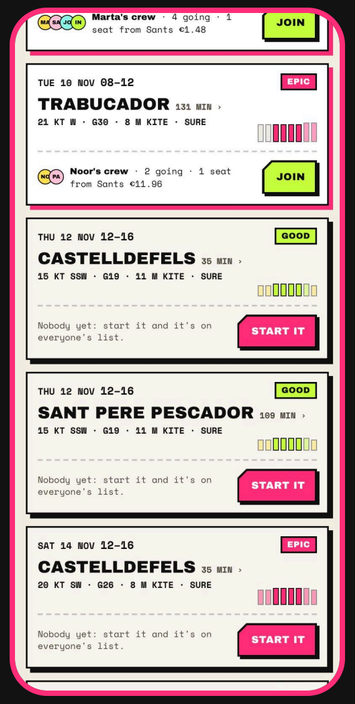
THE SOLUTION

ONE FLOW, FROM FORECAST TO CHECK-IN

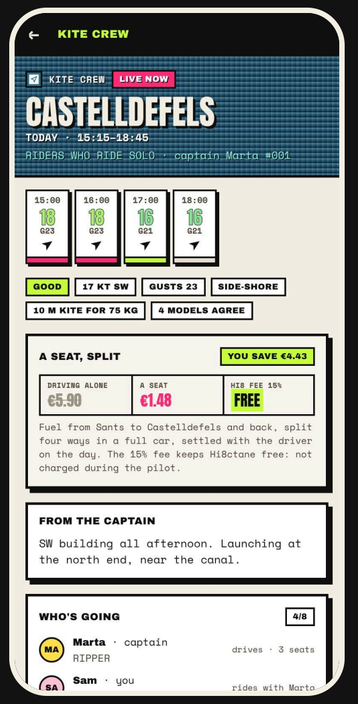
- The day, rated for your level from 4 weather models, hour by hour
- A crew of riders at your level
- A seat from your part of town, the fuel split worked out
- A check-in at the spot: the outing counts



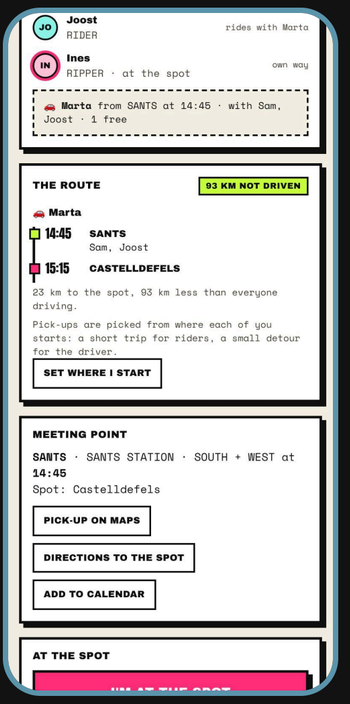
1 · The day



2 · The crew



3 · The seat



4 · The route

Real screens from hi8ctane.com. Live now in Amsterdam, Barcelona and Tarifa. No app to install.

WHY NOW

KITE IS BOOMING

The Dutch kite association estimates several hundred thousand riders in the Netherlands, about ten times more than ten years ago. Olympic since Paris 2024, with a Dutch medal.

SPORT IS SOCIAL

Strava run clubs grew 59% in 2024. Strava has 150M+ users, was valued at $2.2B in 2025 and reportedly filed for an IPO in January 2026.

ONE FOUNDER CAN BUILD IT

Open weather models rate every spot every hour, and AI-assisted engineering let one founder ship this in 23 days.

Participation is booming. Coordination is still a group chat.

Sources: NOS (4 Jun 2026, NKV estimate), Nautica News, Strava Year in Sport 2024, Cycling Weekly (May 2025), SGB Media (Jan 2026)

BUILT AND LIVE. NOW WE PROVE THE BEHAVIOUR.

23 DAYS
from first line to a working app

20
updates shipped to the live site in 8 days

413
automated checks run on every release

27
spots live in Amsterdam, Barcelona and Tarifa

THE 30-DAY BETA, TARGETS TO 9 DEC

Selected beta riders	**50**
Active hosts posting crews	**8–10**
Verified outings (2+ checked in at the spot)	**20**
Partners on a paid pilot	**3**

WHAT INVESTORS GET ON 9 DEC

- Unique riders out, and outings per host
- Share who come back on the next good window
- Bookings we can attribute, and revenue collected
- Cost per activated rider

Product figures from our code, tests and GitHub, 9 Nov 2026. Beta figures are targets, not results.

START WITH KITE. EVERY WEATHER SPORT HAS THE SAME PROBLEM.

10×

more Dutch kiters than ten years ago: several hundred thousand today (NKV)

€3,800

a new kiter's first year: €499 to learn, about €1,800 for a kit, €1,490 for a week away

150M+

people on Strava: outdoor sport scales into a very large network

NOW
Kite in Amsterdam

NEXT
Kite in Barcelona and Tarifa

THEN
Wing, surf, SUP, MTB, MX on the same engine; windsurf next

LATER
Destinations: trips with your crew

Sources: NOS (Jun 2026, NKV estimate), KBC, Surfertoday, Yumping, Cycling Weekly (May 2025)

PARTNERS PAY FOR THE RIDERS WE BRING. THE REST IS UPSIDE.

NOW: WHAT WE SELL

- 10–15% on lessons, rentals, experiences and trips we send
- Founding partners: 0% on their first 20 riders
- A paid pilot: €650 for 8 weeks, credited against commission

€224 to us when a new kiter books a course (€499) and a week away (€1,490)

LATER: ONCE RIDERS COME BACK

- 15% on a seat (about €0.67)
- The Pass €3.99 and the Club €9.99 a month
- Second-hand gear, events, contests, brands

Switched on only when the data says riders return.

One mature city, base case	Partner bookings	Later streams	All in	City costs
A year	**€27K**	€60K	€87K	€27K
Per active rider a year	**€18**	€40	€58	

Riders are the scale lever, not cities: €10M a year takes about 170K active riders with every stream on.

Model figures are hypotheses the beta will test. Base case: 1,500 riders out a month in a mature city. City costs still to be quoted.

THE MARKET ISN'T EMPTY. THE FULL LOOP IS.

	When it's good	Who, at my level	A seat in a car	A counted outing
Forecast apps: Windguru, Windy, Surfline	Yes	–	–	–
Communities: Hanglos, WhatsApp and Facebook groups	Partly: shared tips	Partly	Partly	–
Strava clubs, Meetup	–	Partly: clubs	–	Partly
Duotone Academy app (SPOTS)	–	Partly: who's at a spot	–	Partly: spot check-in
Kite schools: the IKO network	For lessons	In lessons	–	–
BlaBlaCar	–	–	City to city	–
Hi8ctane	**Yes:** 4 models	**Yes:** by level	**Yes:** routed	**Yes:** crew check-in

WHAT COMPOUNDS, AND IS HARD TO COPY

Local hosts with cars, verified outings, repeat crews, trust and partner relationships, city by city. A forecast app can add a chat. It can't add the crews.

From each product's public pages, Nov 2026, incl. Duotone's "Academy App: Introducing SPOTS"

HOW A CITY OPENS, AND WHEN THE NEXT ONE DOES

1

HOSTS FIRST

8–10 riders with cars who post crews

2

50 SELECTED RIDERS

invited from the scene, by level

3

PARTNERS SEND RIDERS

schools and rentals, on founding terms

4

A FOUNDING NIGHT

skate jam and party: the RSVP is the sign-up

5

CONTENT, THEN ADS

Reels twice a week; ads after 20 outings, under €8 a sign-up

THE GATE TO THE NEXT CITY

20 verified outings, 35% back within 30 days, 10 active hosts.

THE ORDER

Amsterdam now. Barcelona next. Tarifa in summer 2027, where travellers from every city meet us.

No paid ads before 20 verified outings. Targets for the beta, not results.

A FOUNDER WHO SHIPS, SELLS AND RIDES

FRANCISCO ARREDONDO · FOUNDER

- **Built and shipped Hi8ctane himself:** a working app in 23 days, 413 automated checks, with AI-assisted engineering
- **8 years of B2B sales across Europe:** rep to commercial director, 3 months as interim CEO, then senior sales in sports nutrition
- Rides kite, MTB and motocross
- Has drawn 350+ people to his own events
- Lives between Amsterdam, Barcelona and Tarifa · B.A. International Business

NEXT, AND AROUND HIM

- First hire: a CTO who owns the architecture, equity earned over time
- A creative crew lined up: film, photo, design, VFX
- Code, brand and accounts held by the founder, assigned to the Dutch BV at incorporation

Stack: Supabase (database), Stripe (payments), Open-Meteo (forecasts), GitHub (code and hosting)

THE ASK

€250K PRE-SEED

15 months of runway (16.4 at zero revenue) · SAFE or convertible note · cap set with the lead

Use	Share	Amount	What it buys
Product and tech	40%	**€100K**	A CTO, founder pay, the App Store and Google Play apps
Growth	25%	**€62.5K**	Hosts, Nights and content: Amsterdam to 300 outings a month
City pilots	15%	**€37.5K**	Barcelona, then Tarifa, on the same playbook
Legal and insurance	10%	**€25K**	The BV, terms, payments review, event cover
Data, hosting, buffer	10%	**€25K**	Commercial forecast data, hosting, a reserve

In 15 months: kite proven in 3 cities, 300 completed outings a month, 35% back within 30 days, 10 partners paying. Then the seed.

Runway: €228.7K planned spend over 15 months plus a €21.3K buffer

WHY INVEST, IN FOUR ANSWERS

WHY THIS

The forecast tells riders when. We get them there: the day, the crew, the car and a counted outing, in one flow.

WHY NOW

Dutch kite is about ten times bigger than a decade ago, social sport is booming, and one founder can now build the whole loop.

WHY US

A founder who shipped the product, sells for a living, rides these sports and knows the first partners.

WHY €250K

It turns working software into a repeatable local marketplace: verified outings, returning riders, paid bookings, a second city.

Kite community → repeat outings → local commerce → repeatable launches → more sports.

APPENDIX · THE CITY MODEL, EVERY ASSUMPTION

A mature city, its third season · all hypotheses	Conservative	Base	Upside
Reachable riders signed up	3,000	6,000	10,000
Out with a crew in a month	20%	25%	30%
Outings per active rider a month	1.5	2	2.5
Partner bookings per 100 riders out, a month	7	10.7	14
Hi8 revenue per booking	€14	€17.7	€20
Paying members, share of sign-ups	2%	3%	4%
Events, contests and brands a year	€15K	€29K	€45K
Revenue a year, all streams	**€30K**	**€87K**	**€201K**
of which partner bookings and second-hand	€7K	€34K	€101K
City costs: part-time lead, marketing, operations	-€20K	-€27K	-€35K
Left for the company	**€10K**	**€60K**	**€166K**

Proven so far: none of these, yet. The beta measures the first four rows. Base-case bookings split: €27K partner bookings, €7K second-hand. Before VAT and payment costs.

APPENDIX · WHAT COULD GO WRONG, AND OUR ANSWER

Risk	How we handle it
Weather and seasons	Six sports on one engine; MTB and MX need no wind; plans and Nights fill the flat days
“We have WhatsApp”	Groups can’t rate the day, find the seat or route the car. Hosts share our crew links there
Riders go off-app	Seats, routes, partner prices and the record of outings all live in the app
Carpool rules	Drivers only share costs, the model a Madrid court upheld for BlaBlaCar in 2017
Safety and liability	We never teach; rookies ride with a captain; partners carry their own cover; terms and insurance budgeted
Holding money	Stripe holds and pays out through Connect; payments stay off until a legal review
Forecast data	A commercial Open-Meteo plan before launch, and a fallback when a model is down

BlaBlaCar ruling: Madrid commercial court, 3 Feb 2017 (The Local)